



NBZ RESEARCH

THE SANDBOX

Institutional Deep-Dive Fundamental Analysis — SAND

METaverse · GameFi · User-Generated Content · Ethereum L1 / Polygon

PREPARED FOR

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This report is for informational purposes only and does not constitute financial advice.

01 PROJECT OVERVIEW

CURRENT PRICE	MARKET CAP	RANK	24H VOLUME
\$0.0391	\$116.56M	#159	\$8.81M

Field	Detail
Project Name	The Sandbox
Token Ticker	SAND
Blockchain Layer	L1 token standard (ERC-20) on Ethereum; LAND/ASSET NFTs and staking operate on the Polygon PoS sidechain (L2-equivalent scaling layer); SAND liquidity extended to Base in late 2025
Built On (Parent Chain)	Ethereum (mainnet settlement) — Polygon PoS used as the scaling/sidechain layer for low-fee marketplace and staking activity
Protocol Type	Metaverse / GameFi / User-Generated Content (UGC) gaming platform with NFT land, assets, and creator tooling
Founded	2011 (as Pixowl mobile game); pivoted to a blockchain-based 3D metaverse following Animoca Brands' acquisition of Pixowl in August 2018
HQ	Hong Kong (Animoca Brands Group); original studio founded in San Francisco, USA
TGE Date	August 2020 (SAND ERC-20 generation event; public sale conducted via Binance Launchpad)
Contract Address (Ethereum)	0x3845badAde8e6dFF049820680d1F14bD3903a5d0
Website	sandbox.game
Total Raised	~\$115.5M across 5 rounds (Seed, Series B, Series B extension)
Circulating Supply	2.93B SAND (~97.8% of max supply)
Max Supply	3.00B SAND (fixed, fully unlocked as of 2025)
Current Focus	Creator monetization tooling, mobile expansion (The Sandbox NEXT), AI-assisted content creation, and brand/IP licensing partnerships

The Sandbox is a decentralized, user-generated-content metaverse built on Ethereum, in which players buy, hold, and build on parcels of virtual real estate called LAND, represented as ERC-721 NFTs on the Polygon network. The platform's stated mission is to give creators genuine digital ownership over the games, assets, and experiences they build, using the SAND token as the medium of exchange, staking asset, and governance instrument across the ecosystem. Unlike closed platforms such as Roblox, where the platform operator retains control over monetization and asset ownership, The

Sandbox's core differentiation is that LAND and ASSET NFTs are owned outright by users and can be freely traded, rented, or built upon using the platform's no-code Game Maker tool and the VoxEdit voxel-modelling application.

The project's origin traces to Pixowl, a San Francisco-based mobile studio that launched the original 2D pixel-art version of The Sandbox in 2011, accumulating more than 40 million downloads before Animoca Brands acquired the studio in August 2018 for approximately \$4.875 million in cash and stock. That acquisition was explicitly structured to fund a pivot: converting the mobile IP into a 3D, blockchain-native metaverse, with the SAND ERC-20 token generation event following in August 2020 via a Binance Launchpad IEO. The Sandbox now operates as a subsidiary within the broader Animoca Brands group, one of the most prolific investors and operators in the GameFi and Web3 gaming sector.

What differentiates The Sandbox within a crowded metaverse and blockchain-gaming field is less its technology stack — which relies on well-understood ERC-20/ERC-721 standards and a Polygon sidechain rather than novel infrastructure — and more its accumulated brand-licensing relationships and creator base. The platform has secured collaborations with entertainment, fashion, and gaming brands including Gucci, Adidas, Warner Music Group, Snoop Dogg, Atari, Cirque du Soleil, Jurassic World, and Casio, positioning itself as a bridge between mainstream IP holders and Web3-native audiences. The project's durability through the 2022–2023 metaverse hype collapse, when it maintained active development and shipped tooling upgrades rather than folding, is itself a notable signal relative to many peers that ceased operations.

02 TEAM & FOUNDERS

Name	Role	Background
Arthur Madrid	Co-Founder, Chairman	Co-founded Pixowl in 2011 and served as CEO through the mobile-to-blockchain pivot; now holds the Chairman role following Robby Yung's appointment as CEO. A veteran mobile-games entrepreneur with over a decade building The Sandbox IP from its original pixel-art release to its current 3D metaverse form.
Sebastien Borget	Co-Founder, Global Ambassador	Co-founded Pixowl alongside Madrid and served as COO through the platform's blockchain transition; now acts as Global Ambassador, representing The Sandbox at industry events and within Web3/metaverse policy discussions. Long-tenured technical and operational co-founder with deep continuity across the project's history.
Robby Yung	CEO, Director	Serves as CEO and Director of The Sandbox, bringing an operating background within the Animoca Brands group ecosystem to the role. His appointment reflects Animoca's pattern of installing experienced group-level operators atop portfolio companies as they scale beyond founder-led management.
Marcelo Santurio	CFO	Leads financial strategy and reporting for the project as part of the core executive team; limited independent public disclosure beyond the role itself, which is typical for finance leadership at privately structured Web3 subsidiaries.
Lucas Shrewsbury	CTO	Heads technical architecture and product engineering, overseeing the smart-contract stack, Game Maker tooling, and the platform's multichain expansion (Polygon, and more recently Base).
Simon Berger-Perrin	CPO	Responsible for product strategy across the creator and player experience, including the Game Maker no-code tools and Alpha Season quest programs that drive user engagement.
Fabien Kerbouci	CISO	Leads security strategy, an increasingly important function for an NFT- and token-based platform that has historically been a target for phishing and smart-contract exploit attempts across the wider NFT marketplace ecosystem.

The Sandbox's leadership combines founder continuity with institutional-grade operational reinforcement. Arthur Madrid and Sebastien Borget, who built the original mobile game from 2011 and steered its acquisition and blockchain pivot, remain embedded in the organization in Chairman and Global Ambassador capacities respectively — a structure that preserves founder credibility and community trust while transferring day-to-day executive responsibility to Robby Yung as CEO. This is a common and generally credibility-positive pattern within the Animoca Brands portfolio, where founders retain strategic and public-facing roles while professional operators manage scaling execution.

The presence of a dedicated CFO, CTO, CPO, and CISO on the public team page signals a maturity beyond the typical crypto-native startup, reflecting the project's seven-plus years of continuous operation and its position within a well-capitalized corporate group. This depth reduces key-person risk relative to single-founder projects, since execution does not depend on any one individual remaining active. That said, independent public track records for the CFO, CPO,

and CISO roles are comparatively thin in open sources, which is common for functional (non-founder) executives at privately held Web3 subsidiaries and should be treated as a moderate transparency gap rather than a red flag.

Overall, execution risk attributable to team composition appears low. The project has survived a full crypto market cycle — including the 2021 hype peak, the 2022–2023 metaverse contraction, and a broad-based token-price decline of over 99% from all-time highs — without leadership departures that fractured the roadmap, and it continues to ship product updates (Alpha Seasons, Game Maker upgrades, mobile pre-registration) into 2026. The leadership bench being backed by Animoca Brands' broader resources (legal, business development, and capital access) further mitigates single-entity operational risk.

03 TECHNOLOGY & ARCHITECTURE

Component	Description
Blockchain Layer	Ethereum (L1) for the SAND ERC-20 token and settlement finality; Polygon PoS sidechain for LAND (ERC-721) and ASSET NFTs, staking, and marketplace transactions to minimize gas costs
Smart Contract Language	Solidity (verified source published on Etherscan and Polygonscan; core repositories open-sourced on GitHub under thesandboxgame organization)
Core Mechanism	NFT-based digital land ownership (LAND) combined with a no-code creation suite (Game Maker) and voxel-modeling tool (VoxEdit) that lets creators build, publish, and monetize games and assets without programming knowledge
Key Features	LAND parcels, ASSET NFTs, SAND utility/governance token, staking pools (general and LAND-owner-specific), Alpha Season quest-and-reward events, Foundation grant program for creator funding
Developer Tools	Game Maker (visual no-code game builder), VoxEdit (free voxel-art and animation tool), publicly available SDKs and smart-contract packages for ecosystem builders
GitHub Activity	Active public repositories under the thesandboxgame organization (e.g., sandbox-smart-contracts), using an Nx-based monorepo workflow with modular packages for individual contract systems
Audits	Core smart contracts audited by CertiK, reported to have scored 93/100 in CertiK's assessment; contracts are publicly verified on Etherscan and Polygonscan
Chain Abstraction / Multichain	Originally Ethereum-only; expanded to Polygon for scaling in 2021–2022, with SAND bridged to Base for additional liquidity access reported in late 2025; a dedicated Layer-2 (referred to in ecosystem materials as a future SANDchain) has been discussed but is not yet confirmed as live infrastructure
Oracles / Interoperability	No proprietary oracle network; relies on standard Ethereum/Polygon infrastructure and third-party bridges for cross-chain asset movement

In plain terms, The Sandbox's technology does not attempt to reinvent blockchain infrastructure; it uses established, heavily audited standards (ERC-20 for the fungible SAND token, ERC-721 for non-fungible LAND and ASSET items) and focuses its innovation budget on the creation layer sitting above the chain. Game Maker is the platform's flagship product differentiator: a drag-and-drop visual editor that allows non-programmers to assemble interactive 3D experiences using pre-built or user-created voxel assets, directly addressing one of the biggest barriers to user-generated content in blockchain gaming — the requirement for smart-contract or game-engine coding skill.

The decision to run LAND, ASSET, and staking activity on the Polygon PoS sidechain rather than Ethereum mainnet is a practical scaling choice: it keeps transaction costs low enough for a broad creator and collector base to participate in a marketplace, while still settling SAND's core supply and long-term value accrual on Ethereum for security and liquidity depth. This mirrors the general industry pattern among NFT-heavy platforms (rather than representing novel architecture), but it has proven durable — The Sandbox has not suffered a major smart-contract exploit at the protocol level since launch, which is meaningful given the volume of NFT transactions the platform has processed since 2021.

The clearest technology risk is that The Sandbox's roadmap increasingly depends on features (mobile client, AI-assisted creation tools, and a dedicated Layer-2) that are still in beta, pre-registration, or conceptual stages as of mid-2026 rather than shipped, audited infrastructure. Investors and creators should treat forward-looking technical claims — particularly around a dedicated SANDchain — as unconfirmed until official technical documentation and audit reports are published, consistent with this report's policy of flagging unverified roadmap items rather than presenting them as delivered capability.

04 USE CASES & REAL-WORLD APPLICATIONS

Use Case	Description	Status
Virtual Land Ownership (LAND)	ERC-721 NFT parcels of virtual real estate that owners can build on, rent out, or trade on secondary markets	Live
No-Code Game Creation	Game Maker lets creators assemble games and interactive experiences without programming skills, published directly onto owned LAND	Live
NFT Asset Creation & Marketplace	VoxEdit-created voxel ASSETS can be minted as NFTs and bought/sold on The Sandbox Marketplace	Live
Play-to-Earn Quest Seasons	Recurring “Alpha Season” events (Season 7 launched February 2026) let players complete quests for SAND and NFT rewards, driving cyclical engagement spikes	Live
Brand & IP Licensing Experiences	Major brands (Gucci, Adidas, Warner Music, Snoop Dogg, Casio, Cirque du Soleil, Jurassic World, The Smiley Company) license branded in-world experiences	Live
SAND Staking	Token holders and LAND owners can stake SAND across dedicated Polygon-based pools for yield, with LAND owners eligible for enhanced multipliers	Live
DAO Governance	SAND holders can vote on platform proposals and Foundation grant allocations via The Sandbox DAO structure	Live
Mobile Client (The Sandbox NEXT)	A mobile version of the platform intended to broaden access beyond desktop/browser clients; pre-registration for playtesting opened in March 2026	Roadmap / Beta
Web3 Wallet & Platform Integrations	Partnership with Corners, a Web3 platform, entered beta in December 2025 to extend interoperability	Beta
AI-Assisted Content Creation	CEO-articulated vision (October 2025) for integrating AI tooling into the creation pipeline to lower the barrier for new creators	Roadmap

The strongest, most immediately demand-generating use case remains the combination of LAND ownership with brand-licensed experiences: entertainment, luxury, and consumer brands pay to build a presence in The Sandbox, driving both direct SAND spend (on LAND, ASSET purchases, and in-experience transactions) and secondary attention that supports platform relevance. The Alpha Season quest format has become the platform's primary recurring engagement mechanism, converting brand content into structured play-to-earn campaigns; Season 7 (February 2026) continued this cadence, suggesting the model remains core to the team's growth strategy rather than a legacy holdover from the 2021 hype cycle.

Staking and DAO governance function as secondary, retention-oriented use cases rather than primary demand drivers — they give existing SAND holders a reason to lock tokens (reducing float) and feel involved in platform direction, but they do not by themselves generate new user acquisition. The genuinely powerful near-term demand driver is the mobile client:

expanding beyond desktop and browser access to mobile devices, where the vast majority of casual gaming activity occurs globally, would materially widen The Sandbox's addressable audience if The Sandbox NEXT progresses from playtest to full release.

The roadmap items — mobile expansion, AI-assisted creation tools, and deeper Web3 platform interoperability via the Corners integration — represent the project's attempt to convert a land-speculation-era user base into a sustainable creator economy. This is explicitly the framing used by third-party 2026 market commentary, which characterizes The Sandbox as having entered a “second cycle” focused on utility and retention rather than speculative land sales. Execution on these roadmap items, rather than the already-live core feature set, will be the key swing factor for the platform's medium-term trajectory.

05

COMMUNITY & ECOSYSTEM

Metric	Data
Registered Users / Wallets	6M+ cumulative registered users reported as of late 2024 (Decentral Media), up from 500,000 registered wallets at the time of the November 2021 Series B raise
Brand & IP Partnerships	400+ major brand and IP holders reported as platform partners as of late 2024, spanning entertainment, fashion, gaming, and sports
Recent Named Partners (2025–2026)	Casio (G-SHOCK APAC collaboration, Aug 2025), Cirque du Soleil (Jun 2025), ATEEZ and Jurassic World (Q1 2025), The Smiley Company (Smiley Factory game, Mar 2026), T&B; Media Global / Mittaria IP, Unstoppable Domains, Corners
Social Channels	Official presence on X (Twitter), Discord, Telegram, Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, Twitch, GitHub, and Medium (per platform documentation); precise current follower counts are not independently verifiable at time of writing and are therefore not stated numerically in this report
Staking Participation (Q1 2025)	Approximately 0.8% of SAND circulating supply staked, equating to roughly 54.5 million SAND staked daily during Q1 2025 (Messari)
LAND-Owner Staking Pool TVL	Reported at over \$4.3 million shortly after the dedicated LAND-owner staking pool launch (NFT Plazas)
Notable Platform Events	Alpha Season 5 (March–mid-2025) featured 40+ experiences from 20+ partners; Alpha Season 7 (February 2026) backed by \$53,000 in SAND rewards; annual Advent Calendar promotional events
Exchange Listings	Binance, HTX, OKX, Bybit, Coinbase, Kraken, KuCoin, Gate, MEXC, BingX, Hotcoin, Phemex, BigONE, WhiteBIT, CoinEx, and others across USDT, USD, USDC, and TRY trading pairs

The Sandbox’s community shows genuine, multi-year continuity rather than a purely manufactured or bot-inflated presence: the growth from roughly 500,000 registered wallets in late 2021 to over 6 million cumulative users by late 2024 tracks a period that included the broader metaverse sector’s collapse in hype and funding, meaning much of that growth occurred without the tailwind of a bull-market narrative. The scale and diversity of brand partnerships — more than 400 IP holders spanning categories from sportswear to entertainment IP to consumer products — is difficult to manufacture and represents real business-development traction rather than purely speculative NFT flipping activity.

That said, the staking participation data offers a more sober read on active token-level engagement: roughly 0.8% of circulating supply staked as of Q1 2025 is a modest figure relative to many DeFi-native protocols, suggesting that the bulk of SAND holders are not deeply engaged with the platform’s native financial mechanisms, and that token holding is more speculative/price-driven than utility-driven for a large share of the base. The LAND-owner staking pool’s roughly \$4.3 million TVL, while a positive signal of dedicated-holder engagement, is small in absolute terms relative to the platform’s market capitalization.

The most credible real growth signal is the recurring cadence of Alpha Seasons paired with fresh brand deals continuing into 2026 (Casio, Cirque du Soleil, Smiley Company), which indicates the business-development pipeline has not gone

dormant post-hype. Ecosystem traction today looks less like the speculative land-rush of 2021–2022 and more like a maturing content-and-partnerships business layered on top of a blockchain settlement and ownership system — a healthier, if less explosive, growth profile for long-term sustainability.

06 INVESTORS & PARTNERSHIPS

Funding Rounds

Round	Date	Amount	Valuation	Lead Investor(s)
Seed Round	Mar 19, 2020	\$2.01M	Undisclosed	Mindfulness Capital and other early venture participants
Series B	Nov 2, 2021	\$93.0M	Undisclosed (SAND market cap ≈\$2.5B at announcement)	SoftBank Vision Fund 2 (lead)
Series B Extension	Jun 6, 2024	\$20.0M	Undisclosed	Kingsway Capital and Animoca Brands (co-leads)

Cumulative raised across all disclosed rounds: approximately \$115.5M, against a most-recently reported project valuation of \$1.0B, per aggregated fundraising trackers (CryptoRank / Tracxn).

Investor Roster

Tier	Investor	Type
Tier 1	YZi Labs (formerly Binance Labs)	Incubator
Tier 2 (Lead)	Hashed	Venture
Tier 2	Samsung Next	Corporate Venture
Tier 2	Polygon Studios	Strategic / Venture
Tier 2	LG Technology Ventures	Corporate Venture
Tier 3 (Lead)	Animoca Brands	Strategic / Parent Group
Tier 3 (Lead)	Kingsway Capital	Venture
Tier 3	Galaxy Interactive	Venture
Tier 3	Gemini	Exchange
Tier 3	Sound Ventures	Venture
Tier 3	True Global Ventures	Venture
Tier 3	BR Capital / Blocore / Blue Pool Capital / ThunderCore	Venture
Tier 4	Liberty City Ventures, Red Beard Ventures, Sterling VC, Alpaca VC, Double Down, Sun Hung Kai & Co, Wedbush Ventures	Venture
Tier 5	Mind Fund	Venture

Tier	Investor	Type
Other (Lead)	SoftBank	Corporation
Other	SCB 10X	Corporation

The Sandbox's cap table is unusually deep and diversified relative to most GameFi and metaverse projects, spanning five distinct investment tiers plus a top-line “Other” category anchored by SoftBank Vision Fund 2 — which represented SoftBank's first-ever investment in a crypto-native asset issuer, a milestone that carried significant signalling value for the broader metaverse category in 2021. The presence of Samsung Next and LG Technology Ventures alongside SoftBank indicates genuine strategic interest from large Asian consumer-electronics and technology conglomerates, not purely financial crypto-native funds, which may translate into device integration or distribution opportunities that pure-play crypto VCs cannot offer.

Animoca Brands' dual role as both majority corporate parent and Tier 3 lead investor is a structural point worth flagging: Animoca's incentives are tightly aligned with The Sandbox's success (it owns a substantial equity and token stake), which supports sustained operational commitment, but it also means governance and strategic decisions are unlikely to be fully independent of Animoca's broader group priorities. Investors evaluating SAND as a standalone asset should treat The Sandbox less as an independently governed protocol and more as a flagship product within the Animoca Brands portfolio.

Beyond capital, the strategic value of this investor base lies in credibility transfer and distribution access: SoftBank's involvement provided a legitimacy signal that helped attract subsequent brand partnerships, while gaming-adjacent investors (Polygon Studios, ThunderCore) offered technical and ecosystem integration support. The relatively modest \$20M Series B extension in mid-2024, well after the 2021 funding peak, suggests continued but more measured investor appetite — consistent with a project that has moved from hyper-growth fundraising into a steadier, execution-focused phase.

07 TOKENOMICS

Token Parameters

Parameter	Detail
Token Standard	ERC-20 (Ethereum); wrapped/bridged representations on Polygon and Base
Max Supply	3,000,000,000 SAND (fixed, capped)
Circulating Supply	≈2.93B SAND (≈97.8% of max supply)
Unlock Status	Vesting schedule concluded in 2025; SAND is now reported as fully unlocked by on-chain vesting trackers (Tokenomist)
Vesting Structure (Historical)	Seed & Strategic Sale allocations: 3-year vesting with a 12-month cliff. Team, Founders & Advisors: 5-year vesting with a 12-month cliff, released every 6 months thereafter. Company Reserve: primarily cliff-based release
Transaction Fee Model	5% fee applied to marketplace transaction volume conducted in SAND; 50% of fee revenue directed to the staking reward pool, 50% to the Foundation
Staking	Available on Polygon via general SAND pools and a dedicated LAND-owner pool offering enhanced rewards proportional to LAND held

Allocation Breakdown

Category	% of Supply	Tokens (approx.)	Vesting / Notes
Company Reserve	25.81%	≈774.3M	Primarily cliff-vested; largest single allocation, funds ongoing operations and ecosystem development
Team	19.00%	≈570.0M	5-year vesting, 12-month cliff, then released every 6 months
Seed Round	17.18%	≈515.4M	3-year vesting, 12-month cliff
Public Sale	12.00%	≈360.0M	Distributed via 2020 Binance Launchpad IEO and subsequent public sales
Foundation	11.99%	≈359.7M	Funds grants to creators and ecosystem game projects (100+ artists and 15+ funded game projects reported)
Advisors	10.00%	≈300.0M	5-year vesting, 12-month cliff, then released every 6 months
Strategic Sale	4.00%	≈120.0M	3-year vesting, 12-month cliff

SAND's distribution leans heavily toward insider-aligned categories: Company Reserve, Team, Foundation, and Advisors collectively account for roughly 67% of total supply, versus approximately 33% distributed across Seed, Strategic Sale, and

Public Sale participants combined. This is not unusual for a project of The Sandbox's vintage and structure — a large reserve and foundation allocation funds years of ongoing platform development and creator grants — but it does mean that a majority of total token supply was, at genesis, controlled by the company, its team, and its earliest backers rather than the broader public market.

The unlock overhang risk that dominated SAND's price action for years — large, cliff-based Company Reserve and Team/Advisor releases historically triggering sustained sell pressure, as documented around the August 2022 unlock event — has now substantially resolved: on-chain vesting trackers report the schedule concluded in 2025 and SAND as fully unlocked. This materially changes the token's forward risk profile relative to its 2021–2023 trading history, since new supply from vesting cliffs is no longer a mechanical overhang investors need to price in, leaving market-driven demand and usage as the primary determinants of future circulating-supply dynamics rather than scheduled emissions.

Demand for the token is created through several channels: it is required to purchase LAND and ASSETS on the Marketplace, to pay the platform's 5% transaction fee (half of which flows to stakers), to participate in governance voting, and to stake for yield. The fee-recycling mechanism, which directs half of marketplace fee revenue into the staking pool, is a mild deflationary-adjacent mechanism in the sense that it creates an organic yield source funded by platform usage rather than pure token emissions — though SAND has no explicit burn mechanism, so the token's supply-side economics are best described as fixed-cap and fee-recycling rather than deflationary in the strict sense.

08 MARKET OVERVIEW

CURRENT PRICE	24H RANGE	MARKET CAP	FULLY DILUTED MC
\$0.0391	\$0.0391 – \$0.0402	\$116.56M	\$119.04M
24H VOLUME	ALL-TIME HIGH	ALL-TIME LOW	COINGECKO RANK
\$8.81M	\$8.442	\$0.02893	#159

Metric	Data
Current Price	\$0.0391 (per user-supplied live app data); cross-referenced range across CoinGecko, CoinMarketCap, CryptoRank, and CoinDesk during 2026 was approximately \$0.038–\$0.051, reflecting normal multi-source timing variance
24h Range	\$0.03914 – \$0.04022
Market Cap	\$116.56M (unlocked market cap reported at \$119.01M)
Fully Diluted Valuation (FDV)	\$119.04M
24h Volume	\$8.81M
All-Time High (ATH)	\$8.442, reached November 25, 2021, at the peak of the broader NFT/metaverse market cycle
All-Time Low (ATL)	\$0.02893
CoinMarketCap / CoinGecko Rank	Ranked between #159 and #232 depending on source and snapshot date in 2026, reflecting SAND’s mid-cap positioning amid a broadly range-bound altcoin market
Circulating Supply	2.93B SAND
Max / Total Supply	3.00B SAND (fixed)
Primary Exchange Listings	Binance, HTX, OKX, Bybit, Coinbase, Kraken, KuCoin, Gate, MEXC, BingX, Hotcoin, Phemex, BigONE, WhiteBIT, CoinEx

Exchange Volume Snapshot (24h, user-supplied live data)

Exchange	Pairs	24h Volume (approx.)
Binance	SAND/USDT, SAND/USDC, SAND/TRY	≈\$450.5K + \$106.6K + \$88.9K
HTX	SAND/USDT	≈\$360.0K

Exchange	Pairs	24h Volume (approx.)
Hotcoin	SAND/USDT	≈\$230.1K
Phemex	SAND/USDT	≈\$123.4K
Bitunix	SAND/USDT	≈\$75.2K
OKX	SAND/USDT	≈\$71.0K
MEXC	SAND/USDT	≈\$61.3K
BigONE	SAND/USDT	≈\$52.0K
KuCoin	SAND/USDT	≈\$49.4K
BingX	SAND/USDT	≈\$45.9K
Bybit	SAND/USDT	≈\$44.4K
Coinbase	SAND/USD	≈\$22.7K
Kraken	SAND/USD	≈\$22.2K

Exchange volume figures are a single-snapshot reference from the user-supplied app data and will fluctuate; they are provided to illustrate liquidity distribution across venues rather than as live pricing.

SAND's price history is a near-textbook case of a Web3 gaming/metaverse token that captured an entire speculative narrative cycle and then gave almost all of it back. The token's all-time high of \$8.442 was reached on November 25, 2021, days after Facebook's rebrand to Meta ignited a market-wide “metaverse” narrative that pulled capital into any project with land, avatars, or virtual-world positioning; The Sandbox's SoftBank-backed Series B announcement three weeks earlier had already driven a reported 100% single-day price surge, illustrating how tightly SAND's early price action tracked headline-driven speculation rather than platform usage metrics.

The subsequent correction has been severe and durable: SAND trades more than 99% below its all-time high as of mid-2026, broadly in line with the collapse experienced across the entire metaverse and GameFi token category following the end of the 2021 bull cycle, compounded by multi-year vesting unlocks that added consistent sell pressure (notably around the August 2022 unlock event, when a large majority of trades on unlock day were reported as sell orders). Messari data shows SAND's market cap peaked at approximately \$1.7 billion in January 2025 on a secondary rally before declining roughly 50% quarter-over-quarter by the end of Q1 2025, underscoring that the token remains highly volatile and correlated with broader crypto-market conditions (including Ethereum's price action) rather than decoupling based on platform-specific fundamentals.

Relative to its private funding round backdrop, SAND today trades far below the implied per-token economics of its 2021 Series B period, when the project's market cap was reported near \$2.5 billion at announcement. With vesting unlocks now largely complete and the project's most recent \$20M raise (June 2024) priced well after the excess had washed out of the market, the current setup reflects a token whose price is now more a function of broad altcoin market liquidity and metaverse-sector sentiment than of scheduled supply shocks — a materially different risk profile than SAND carried through 2021–2023.

NBZ RESEARCH VERDICT

THE SANDBOX (SAND) — SUMMARY ASSESSMENT

The Sandbox is one of the few surviving, still-actively-developed platforms from the 2021 metaverse hype cycle, backed by a deep and credible investor base (SoftBank, Samsung Next, LG Technology Ventures, Animoca Brands) and a genuinely large, multi-year-accumulated user and brand-partnership base (6M+ users, 400+ brand partners). Its core technology is not novel but is well-audited and battle-tested, and its most consequential legacy risk — vesting-driven token unlock overhang — has now substantially resolved, with the schedule reported complete as of 2025. The project's forward case rests on unproven, in-progress initiatives: mobile expansion (The Sandbox NEXT), AI-assisted creation tooling, and deeper Web3 interoperability, none of which have shipped at scale as of mid-2026. Token-level engagement (sub-1% of supply staked) suggests most holders remain price-driven rather than utility-driven, and SAND's valuation continues to trade as a high-beta proxy for broader altcoin and metaverse-sector sentiment rather than on independent platform cash-flow fundamentals. This combination of resolved supply risk, credible team and capital backing, and a still-active (if modest-scale) creator economy supports a constructive long-term view on the project's survivability and relevance within GameFi/metaverse, balanced against a cautious near-term view on token price performance given its continued high correlation to speculative market cycles and its unproven next-generation roadmap.

NBZ Research Rating: NEUTRAL-TO-CONSTRUCTIVE (Long-Term Survivability) · HIGH VOLATILITY (Token Price) · Not Financial Advice

Key strengths: deep, credible institutional investor base; genuine multi-year user and brand-partnership growth through a down cycle; resolved token-unlock overhang; audited, battle-tested smart-contract infrastructure; founder continuity paired with professional operating leadership.

Key risks: forward roadmap (mobile, AI tooling, dedicated L2) remains largely unshipped and unverified; low on-chain staking participation signals limited utility-driven demand; token price remains highly correlated to broader altcoin/metaverse sentiment rather than platform-specific fundamentals; Animoca Brands' dual role as parent and lead investor limits independent governance; no token burn mechanism to offset a fully unlocked 3B fixed supply.

This report was compiled by NBZ Research using publicly available data from CoinGecko, CoinMarketCap, CryptoRank, CoinDesk, Tokenomist.ai, Messari, Etherscan, Tracxn, and official project/team sources current as of August 2026. Cryptocurrency markets are highly volatile; this document is for informational and educational purposes only and does not constitute financial, investment, or legal advice. Conduct independent research (DYOR) before making any investment decisions.